



This oil painting shows Henri II of France and Philip II of Spain meeting at Cateau-Cambrésis on April 3, 1559 to sign the peace treaty. In reality, it was signed by their ambassadors.

THE TENSE RELATIONS BETWEEN the Portuguese,

who had been attempting to establish trading posts in China since 1513, and the **Chinese**, always suspicious of Portuguese intentions, had thawed during the 1540s to the point that by 1552 China agreed to allow **Portugal a trading post in Macau** on the south coast of China. It was the key foothold the Portuguese had been seeking. By 1557, this temporary settlement had become permanent. It would, in turn, prove a crucial link in the Portuguese, later Spanish, global trading system. Macau remained Portuguese until 1999.

In 1557, **Mary I of England** (see 1552–54) was persuaded by her husband Philip II to join Spain in its renewed **war with France**. This proved disastrous, leading directly to the **loss of Calais to the French** in January 1558; Calais had been English since 1360 and was the country's last foothold in continental Europe. Mary had been unable to have children and when she died in November 1558, she was succeeded by her Protestant half-sister Elizabeth I, the daughter of Anne Boleyn.

Capture of Calais

This enamel plaque by French artist Leonard Limosin celebrates the capture of Calais by French forces led by Francis, Duke of Guise on January 7, 1558.

KEY

- Territory of Moscow 1300–1505
- Expansion of Moscow 1505–1584

Expansion of Moscow

In 1547, Ivan IV transformed the Grand Duchy of Moscow into the Czarism of Russia. In the 1550s, he began the expansion of its boundaries, and its territory and population doubled during his reign.



The **Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis** of April 1559 marked the definitive **end of the Italian Wars**. It proved a short-lived success. Habsburg Spain was the clear victor, its dominance in Italy absolute (at the expense of the papacy as much as of France). For its part, France kept Calais as well as Metz, Toul, and Verdun. By the terms of the treaty, Philip II

was tacitly making plain that the military and financial contributions of the Netherlands to the conflict had been principally to advance Spain's Italian goals. Future conflict in the Spanish Netherlands was more or less guaranteed. A less

predictable consequence was the **death of the French king, Henry II** (b. 1519) three months later in a tournament held to celebrate the treaty. The succession of boy-kings that followed led France to 40 years of bitter civil war (see 1572).

In 1558, **Czar Ivan IV** continued his policy of **Russian expansion** with the beginning of the settlement of the Khanate of Sibir (western Siberia). Ivan's conquest of Kazan in 1552 had opened up the way to the Urals and Siberia to the east. Colonization was led by rich merchants, such as the Stroganovs, who had been granted estates and tax privileges by Ivan in the lands they took. Protected by Cossacks, **large-scale migration** into Siberia followed in the 1570s, establishing trade links with local tribes. The Khanate of Sibir was eventually conquered in 1582, greatly increasing the size of Russia.



Akbar the Great in procession

During the 46-year reign of Akbar, Mughal India enjoyed expansion of territory, prosperity, religious tolerance, and cultural richness.

significantly boosted. Although his efforts in the west were thwarted by Lithuanian arms, those to the south were strikingly successful. He had already conquered the Khanate of Kazan in 1552. In 1556, he achieved an even more notable breakthrough, destroying the enfeebled Khanate of Astrakhan.

Russia now found itself not only in control of the **trade routes to Central Asia**, it was also poised to sweep eastward across Siberia.

- January 27, 1556** Accession of Akbar (1542–1605) to Mughal throne
- July 31, 1556** Death of Ignatius of Loyola, founder of Jesuits (b. 1491)
- March 21, 1556** Thomas Cranmer, former Archbishop of Canterbury, executed for heresy
- November 5, 1556** Akbar defeats Hindus at Second Battle of Panipat
- 1556** Russians seize Khanate of Astrakhan and reach Caspian Sea
- 1556** John III of Sweden becomes ruler of Finland

- September 1, 1557** Death of French explorer Jacques Cartier (b. 1491)
- September 1, 1557** England allies with Spain and declares war on France
- August 10, 1557** French at St. Quentin
- 1557** Portuguese take possession of Macau, China
- September 21, 1558** Death of Charles V, Holy Roman Emperor (b. 1500)
- 1558** Ivan the Terrible begins conquest of Khanate of Sibir
- June 20, 1559** Henry II of France killed in jousting tournament plunging French monarchy into crisis
- 1559** Margaret of Parma, daughter of Charles V, becomes Governor of Netherlands
- July 10, 1559** Francis II becomes king of France
- 1559** Spanish settlement founded, Mobile Bay, Alabama
- April 2–3, 1559** Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis marks end of Italian Wars
- November 17, 1558** Accession of Elizabeth I following death of Mary I (b. 1516)
- January 7, 1558** French counterattack English and capture Calais